

Search Engine Optimization Website Audit

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Website Optimization

On-Page Optimization

After analyzing the site crawl, I first recommend addressing the missing URLs on the XML sitemap. An XML sitemap is essential for a website because it ensures that search engine crawlers can quickly identify files and content on each website page. Not having all the URLs in the XML sitemap makes it harder for web pages to appear in search results. Adding missing URLs to the XML sitemap will allow crawlers to index each page, leading to their appearance in search results.

The second strategy I recommend is to identify the missing headers and meta descriptions and add information for them. A header helps visitors and search engine crawlers understand a page's topic and ensures website organization. It is important to make the header descriptive but brief. A meta description is a short summary that appears below a webpage link on search engine results pages. It helps the search engines to understand what the page is all about and what it has to offer. Meta descriptions are mainly used as the page description that shows up below the page title in search results, and search engines use this to display a snippet of the web page. It is important to create a meta description that is helpful for both the search engine and searchers and shows what content is on the page.

Technical Optimization

After analyzing the technical report of the site crawl, the third strategy is to optimize images and text that are taking too long to load on the website. The performance metrics that we

need to focus on are the Largest Contentful Paint (LCP), First Contentful Paint (FCP), Total Blocking Time (TBT), and Time to Interactive (TTI).

When the LCP and FCP take too long, the website's loading time increases, leading to a slow load time (TBT) and a delayed page interactive time (TTI). To avoid poor user experience, I recommend decreasing the LCP to around 2.5 seconds and the FCP to around 2 seconds.

Optimizing the images and text that take too long to load is an essential step towards faster loading times and improving the page's loading speed. A high LCP will lead to slow loading times, resulting in poor user experience and ultimately leading to users leaving the website. Therefore, optimizing images and text will enhance the user experience and help retain more users, positively impacting the website's overall performance.

Backlink Building Strategies

In order to optimize a website and improve its search engine rankings, a well-planned link-building strategy is crucial. Backlinks play a vital role in this strategy as they help establish a website's authority and credibility.

One of the first strategies that I suggest for Ficus Communications is to conduct an analysis of the 267,000 backlinks that are linking to their website. This analysis would help to understand the context of those links and ensure that they are credible and do not have any negative associations. This strategy can also help identify any broken links that point to content on the website. Replacing these broken links ensures that the content other websites are linking to is still relevant and visible to users.

To improve the online visibility of Ficus Communications' website, I suggest creating and promoting engaging and relevant content for the target audience. If the content is compelling

enough, it can attract more links from other websites that would want to link back to the company's website. Additionally, promoting the content on various marketing channels will ensure that the content reaches the target audience and other websites.

A third strategy I recommend for increasing visibility is the skyscraper strategy. This strategy involves identifying popular content that ranks well for other competitors in our industry and creating even better versions of it. Creating this improved content can increase visibility to users and competitors, where competitors might want to link the improved content version, leading to increased traffic and visibility.

By implementing these effective strategies, we can significantly enhance the website's credibility and influence while also boosting its online presence and exposing the company to a broader audience.

Harmful Backlink Building Strategies

While backlinks are essential to create a successful link-building strategy for optimizing a website, it is important to know that not all link-building techniques are practical, and some may even harm a website's reputation. Search engines penalize websites that engage in manipulative or spammy link-building practices.

One harmful strategy for link building is buying links to improve a website's search engine rankings. However, this can backfire if the links are purchased from low-quality or non-credible spammy websites. Search engines like Google have algorithms that can detect such unethical practices and penalize the website. This can negatively impact the website's reputation, which can be difficult to recover from. The website may also experience a significant drop in its search engine ranking, which can lead to reduced visibility and traffic. Websites that engage in

such practices may also risk being completely de-indexed by search engines. This means that the website will not appear in search engine results, leading to a significant loss of traffic and potential customers. In order to avoid such negative consequences, website owners must avoid buying links from non-credible sources.

One strategy that some websites may resort to is link spamming, which involves creating an excessive amount of links with the intent of manipulating the search engine's authority signals. However, this practice is viewed as a spammy tactic and can have severe consequences for the website. Search engines recognize and penalize link spamming, which may result in lower page rankings or removal from search results. Ficus Communications should avoid engaging in link spamming to ensure the website's long-term success.

To maintain the website's credibility and visibility in the long run, Ficus Communications must avoid resorting to harmful backlink-building strategies. By avoiding such practices, Ficus Communications can build a strong, sustainable online presence that attracts genuine traffic and leads to better engagement with its audience.

References

Wiideman, S., & Cowley, S. (2021). *SEO: Strategy & skills*. Edify Publishing.